

183 Go on an orienteering event

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If you like treasure hunts, you will love orienteering. The goal of this sport is to use specially drawn maps to find a sequence of flags or points on a set course in the fastest-possible time.

What you need

- Orienteering map
- Compass • Sneakers or walking shoes
- Comfortable clothes
- Waterproof jacket

1 Find a local orienteering activity near you and sign up for it. It may be a countryside course, but it could also be held in a park, in a town, or a city center.

2 Become familiar with orienteering maps.

They usually use five colors to stand for different things:

- Black = tall buildings or cliffs
- Brown = landforms, such as gullies or hills
- Blue = water features
- Green = wooded areas
- Yellow = open areas

3 Practice using a compass. Orienteering maps are drawn using magnetic north, so learn how to find north on your compass.



Find your way around the map's course

184 Practice your geocaching skills

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Take part in a real global treasure hunt. Players use GPS coordinates to lead them to “cached” (hidden) boxes of “treasure”—toys, badges, slips of paper—hidden in the countryside. See www.geocaching.com

